

Essential DevOps Tools Cheat Sheet for Cloud Beginners

Navigating the massive world of Cloud and DevOps can feel confusing when starting out. Mastering these fundamental tools will give you the practical skills needed for your first entry-level cloud job.

What you'll learn:

- 1 Containerizing Apps with Docker
- 2 Creating Cloud Servers with Terraform
- 3 Managing Cloud Storage via AWS CLI
- 4 Debugging Live Applications with Kubectl

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TIP 1 OF 4

Containerizing Apps with Docker

Docker creates isolated environments called containers so your app runs the exact same way on any laptop or cloud server. Instead of manually setting up databases and runtimes, Docker packages everything into a single unit. You can start a working web server in seconds with just one command line.

```
$ docker run -d -p 8080:80 --name my-web-server nginx
```

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Creating Cloud Servers with Terraform

Instead of manually clicking through browser menus in cloud consoles, Terraform lets you define cloud infrastructure in simple text code. This eliminates clicking mistakes and allows you to recreate your complete server setup automatically whenever needed.

```
$resource "aws_instance" "web" {  
  ami          = "ami-0c55b159cbfafa1f0"  
  instance_type = "t2.micro"  
}
```

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Managing Cloud Storage via AWS CLI

The AWS Command Line Interface allows you to interact with cloud resources directly from your terminal window prompt. It is significantly faster than navigating browser menus and essential for automating everyday cloud tasks inside scripts.

```
$aws s3 sync ./my-static-site s3://my-company-web-bucket
```

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Debugging Live Applications with Kubectl

When applications run inside Kubernetes clusters, you need a quick way to inspect their live output without logging into physical servers. The `kubectl logs` command lets you stream real-time application logs directly onto your terminal screen for fast troubleshooting.

```
$kubectl logs -f deployment/web-api --tail=50
```


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Key Takeaways

- + Master basic Linux terminal commands before moving into complex cloud tools.
- + Track all your infrastructure files and automation code inside Git.
- + Clean up temporary cloud resources daily to prevent unexpected personal bills.
- + Focus on building hands-on projects instead of just reading theoretical docs.
- + Write simple README files explaining how your code and projects work.

Watch Out For

- ! Trying to learn 10 tools at once instead of mastering Docker and Git first.
- ! Hardcoding secret API keys or cloud passwords into public code repositories.
- ! Leaving cloud instances running overnight while testing beginner projects.
- ! Copy-pasting commands without reading what the flags and options do.

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